

Lichen Zhu

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EDUCATION

Duke University

M.S. in Electrical and Computer Engineering

Durham, NC

Sep. 2025 – Jul. 2027

Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University / University of Liverpool

B.Sc. in Financial Mathematics, First Class Honours

Suzhou, China

Sep. 2021 – Jul. 2025

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Duke University, Department of Electrical and Computer Engineering

Durham, NC

Research Assistant, Center for Computational Evolutionary Intelligence (CEI)

Sep. 2025 – Present

- Conduct research on multimodal large language models, long-context memory, video understanding, and efficient AI systems with Yueqian Lin, Yudong Liu, and Prof. Yiran Chen.
- Develop methods and evaluation frameworks for efficient vision-language model inference, long-term interaction memory, and robust multimodal reasoning.

Hefei University of Technology

Hefei, China

Research Assistant

Jun. 2026 – Present

- Conduct research on long-form video understanding and efficient video reasoning with Prof. Yanbin Hao and Dr. Shuo Wang.

PUBLICATIONS

Will My Assistant Remember My Allergy? What Personal LLM Assistants Forget When Conversation Memory Is Compressed

L. Zhu, Y. Lin, Y. Wang, Y. Liu, H. Li, Y. Chen

HumanSys 2026, Oral Presentation (co-located with ACM MobiCom 2026) [arXiv:2609.05767](https://arxiv.org/abs/2609.05767).

When No Answer Is Correct: Diagnosing Absent Answer Detection for MLLMs in Video Understanding

Y. Wang, Y. Lin, L. Zhu, Y. Liu, H. Li, Y. Chen

EMNLP 2026. [arXiv:2606.08239](https://arxiv.org/abs/2606.08239).

MANUSCRIPTS

Semantic-Unit Aggregation for Streaming Interaction Memory

L. Zhu, Y. Lin, Y. Wang, H. Li, Y. Chen

Under review at AAAI 2027.

Stable Scores, Unstable Answers: Frame Phase and Option Order in Video Multiple-Choice Evaluation

L. Zhu, Y. Lin, Y. Wang, H. Li, Y. Chen

Under review at ICASSP 2027.

Knowing When to Trust a Prior: Reliability-Gated Cue Fusion for Video Gaze Prediction

L. Zhu, Y. Wang, Y. Lin, H. Li, Y. Chen

Under review at ICASSP 2027.

Coupled but late: Turn-taking between full-duplex speech models in unscripted dialogue

L. Zhu, Y. Lin, Y. Wang, H. Li, Y. Chen

Under review at ICASSP 2027.

Not every question is yours: Learning whom to answer in multi-party dialogue

L. Zhu, Y. Lin, Y. Wang, H. Li, Y. Chen

Under review at ICLR 2027.

Query-Conditioned Evidential Keyframe Sampling for MLLM-Based Long-Form Video Understanding

Y. Wang, L. Zhu, Y. Lin, Y. Liu, J. Zhang, H. Li, Y. Chen

Under review at WACV 2027.

Cross-Codec KV cache Transfer For LLM-Based Text-TO-Speech

Y. Lin, L. Zhu, Y. Wang, Y. Liu, H. Li, Y. Chen

Under review at ICASSP 2027.

Recurrent Audio-Visual Memory for Robotic Insertion Verification

Y. Wang, Y. Lin, L. Zhu, H. Li, Y. Chen

Under review at ICASSP 2027.

Hierarchical Visual-Language Memory for Test-Time Adaptation of Multimodal Large Language Models

Y. Chang, T. Lei, L. Zhu, S. Wang, Y. Hao

Under review at ICASSP 2027.

StyleVAR: Controllable Image Style Transfer via Visual Autoregressive Modeling

L. Jing, D. Zhang, P. Li, **L. Zhu**, Y. Xu, H. Xing

Preprint [arXiv:2604.21052](#).

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Duke University

Durham, NC

Incoming Teaching Assistant – Modern Analytics & Machine Intelligence

Oct. 2026 – Dec. 2026

- Support DECISION 546Q: Modern Analytics: Data, Prediction, and Actions and DECISION 894: Transforming Tech Analytics with Machine Intelligence.
- Provide office hour support and grade assignments covering machine learning, deep learning, and generative models implemented with Python and PyTorch.

Duke University

Durham, NC

Teaching Assistant – DECISION 520Q: Data Science for Business

Sep. 2026 – Oct. 2026

- Supported an MQM data science course through weekly office hours, grading, and technical guidance on R programming, statistical analysis, case studies, and final projects.

China Construction Bank

Hefei, China

Financial Technology Intern

Jul. 2022 – Sep. 2022

- Engineered behavioral features from large-scale transaction data using SQL and Python for downstream financial analytics.

HONORS & AWARDS

Duke University Master’s Scholarship, \$18,000.

XJTLU Outstanding Graduate, 2025.

National Inspirational Scholarship, Ministry of Education of China, 2024.

XJTLU Outstanding Student, 2023–2024.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Reviewer: IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP), 2027.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python (PyTorch, NumPy, Pandas), SQL, R, MATLAB, Java

Research Areas: Multimodal Large Language Models, Vision-Language Models, Long-Form Video Understanding, Long-Term Memory for LLM Agents, Efficient AI Systems

Mathematical Foundations: Probability and Statistics, Optimization, Stochastic Processes, Monte Carlo Methods

Languages: Mandarin Chinese (Native), English (Fluent)